Project: the Sargon Birth Legend → Hebrew

Corpus: `../corpus.md` (read it, `../renderings.md` and `../translator-brief--kings.md` first).

Scope

All the lines in the base text: King's col. I 1–32 (K 3401 + Sm 2118 obverse, with K 4470 col. I and BM 47449) and
col. II 1–17 (K 4470 col. II) – 49 entries, in `annotated.rtl.md` (labels `I.1` … `II.17`).

Base text – and its limits (read this first)

- **The only open transliteration reachable on 2026-10-21 is King 1907** (vol. II pp. 87–96; public domain), which we
  transcribed by hand from the page images (`../../sources/King-1907--.../legend-of-sargon--King-1907-pp87-96.md`).
  It is a 1907 edition (rank 5 as an edition): its readings of the logograms and some signs are old, and it does not
  know K 7249 (CT 46 46), the fourth manuscript.
- **Checked against:** the eBL fragmentarium catalogue (no transliteration of K 3401+, K 4470 or K 7249; BM 47449 has
  only col. 4′, which belongs to another text – see below); the eBL dictionary for every word (per word); and the
  modern translation of ll. 1–14 by Westenholz 1997, quoted on the web (rank 3; brief quotations only).
- **Not reachable** (records: `../../sources/_records-only--Legends-of-kings/`): Westenholz 1997 (the current edition,
  © Eisenbrauns, not open access), Lewis 1980 (©; archive.org lending only and archive.org blocked), CT 13 42–43 and
  CT 46 46 (the copies; archive.org), CDLI P365306 / P365307 / P365303 (cdli.earth "temporarily offline", HTTP 503, all
  day 2026-10-21), Jiménez 2018 (BM 47449's edition).

- **Therefore:** every line is translated from King's transliteration as printed; where the modern reading is known to
  differ (from Westenholz's translation, or from the eBL dictionary's logograms), the apparatus says so and the Hebrew
  marks the point with `?` or `...`; nothing is filled from memory. **The user should get Westenholz 1997 (pp. 36–49)
  to check the whole text**, and K 7249 (lines Westenholz adds) is not translated (gap recorded).
- **BM 47449, rev. col. 4′** (eBL's only transliterated lines of the tablet: `gu₂-gal-li-ia`, `ana mar-ri-ia`,
  `A-MEŠ ul a-ṣa-pi` …) is edited by Jiménez 2018 among *disputation and fable extracts*: it is most likely not the
  Sargon legend and is not translated here.

Line numbering

King's col. I 1–32, col. II 1–17. Westenholz and Lewis number continuously (and add K 7249); their numbers are not
available to us. In King's col. I, ll. 2 and 3 are one line on K 3401 (divided by a mark).

The parallels that matter for the commentary

Exod 2:1–10 (the mother, the concealment, the basket, the bitumen, the river, drawn out, raised as a son); Exod 1:22;
2:16–19 (the drawing of water); Gen 10:8–12 (Akkad); Isa 20:1 (Sargon II); the royal boast (Isa 10:13–14; 37:24–25).

Open decisions

(Collected below.)

Progress